

# READ TO SPEAK

REAL ENGLISH.  
REAL **PROGRESS**.

# B2

## ADVANCED

Take your English  
to the next level.  
Speak with **confidence**.



Engaging passages on  
diverse and challenging  
topics



15 target words with  
in-context meanings



Word-tracking grid –  
your signature method



Speaking prompts to  
express your ideas

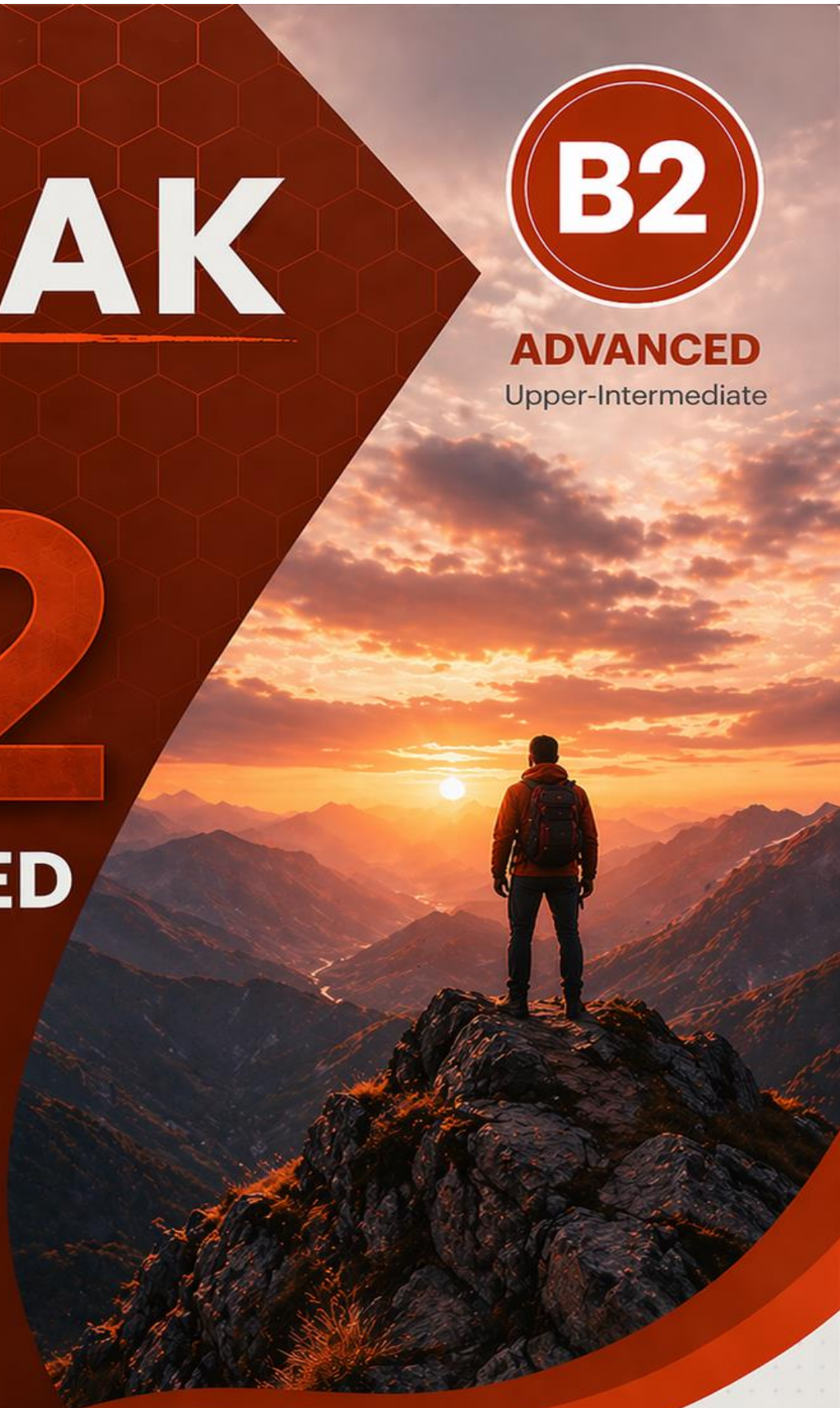


Grammar focus drawn  
from the passage



**ADVANCED**  
Upper-Intermediate

by  
**Ahmed Magdy**



# READ TO SPEAK

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## B2 — Advanced

Upper-Intermediate

Abstract, nuanced, and intellectually rich passages. Vocabulary includes sophisticated everyday and academic language.

|           |                |                   |
|-----------|----------------|-------------------|
| <b>12</b> | <b>15</b>      | <b>270–320</b>    |
| units     | words per unit | words per passage |

**Each unit contains:**

- A rich, engaging passage on a meaningful topic
- 15 target words with in-context meanings
- Word-tracking grid, your signature method
- Speaking prompts designed to activate the vocabulary
- Grammar focus drawn directly from the passage
- Review unit every 3 units, recycling vocabulary

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Unit 1 · Perception · We see what we expect to see

The human brain is not a camera. It does not record the world as it is. It constructs what we perceive, building a model of reality based on incomplete sensory data, filled in by expectation, memory, and prior experience. What we call 'seeing' is largely an act of interpretation.

Psychologists have demonstrated this repeatedly. In one famous experiment, participants watching a video of people passing a basketball failed to notice a person in a gorilla suit walking through the middle of the scene. They were so focused on counting passes that their brains simply did not register the gorilla. This is known as 'inattention blindness'.

But the implications go far beyond party tricks. We filter our social world in the same way. We interpret other people's behaviour through the lens of our own history, assumptions, and emotional state. We see what we expect to see, and then we mistake our interpretation for reality.

This is important to understand because our perceptions drive our responses. If you believe someone is being hostile, you will respond as if they are hostile, even if they are simply stressed, tired, or preoccupied. Understanding that perception is constructed, not received, is the beginning of a more considered, and considerably more accurate, relationship with the world.

## Vocabulary

| Word                  | Part of speech             | Meaning in context                                                   | Example                                               |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>perceive</b>       | <i>verb</i>                | To become aware of something through the senses or mind              | <i>We perceive the world through our assumptions.</i> |
| <b>sensory</b>        | <i>adjective</i>           | Relating to the senses (sight, sound, touch, etc.)                   | <i>Sensory data shapes our reality.</i>               |
| <b>interpretation</b> | <i>noun</i>                | An explanation or understanding of something                         | <i>Perception is an act of interpretation.</i>        |
| <b>demonstrated</b>   | <i>verb (past)</i>         | Proved or shown clearly through evidence                             | <i>Research has demonstrated this effect.</i>         |
| <b>inattentional</b>  | <i>adjective</i>           | Relating to the failure to notice something due to focused attention | <i>Inattentional blindness is well documented.</i>    |
| <b>implications</b>   | <i>noun (pl.)</i>          | Likely consequences or effects of something                          | <i>The implications are far-reaching.</i>             |
| <b>lens</b>           | <i>noun (metaphorical)</i> | A way of interpreting or viewing something                           | <i>See the world through a different lens.</i>        |
| <b>hostile</b>        | <i>adjective</i>           | Showing strong dislike or opposition; aggressive                     | <i>Don't interpret stress as hostility.</i>           |
| <b>preoccupied</b>    | <i>adjective</i>           | Absorbed in thought; distracted                                      | <i>He was preoccupied and didn't notice.</i>          |
| <b>considered</b>     | <i>adjective</i>           | Carefully thought about before acting                                | <i>A considered response is more accurate.</i>        |

|                   |                  |                                                        |                                                    |
|-------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>constructs</b> | <i>verb</i>      | Builds or creates something, especially a mental model | <i>The brain constructs our reality.</i>           |
| <b>register</b>   | <i>verb</i>      | To notice or be aware of something                     | <i>Our brains fail to register certain things.</i> |
| <b>prior</b>      | <i>adjective</i> | Existing or coming before in time                      | <i>Prior experience shapes perception.</i>         |
| <b>assumption</b> | <i>noun</i>      | Something accepted as true without proof               | <i>Question your assumptions.</i>                  |
| <b>drive</b>      | <i>verb</i>      | To cause or strongly influence something               | <i>Perceptions drive behaviour.</i>                |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                  | Part of speech             | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses          | Example I used it                   |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>perceive</b>       | <i>verb</i>                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>sensory</b>        | <i>adjective</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>interpretation</b> | <i>noun</i>                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>demonstrated</b>   | <i>verb (past)</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>inattentional</b>  | <i>adjective</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>implications</b>   | <i>noun (pl.)</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>lens</b>           | <i>noun (metaphorical)</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>hostile</b>        | <i>adjective</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>preoccupied</b>    | <i>adjective</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>considered</b>     | <i>adjective</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>constructs</b>     | <i>verb</i>                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>register</b>       | <i>verb</i>                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>prior</b>          | <i>adjective</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>assumption</b>     | <i>noun</i>                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>drive</b>          | <i>verb</i>                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>Total</b>          |                            |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <u>  </u> /75 | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|   |                                                                                             |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Can you think of a time when your perception of a situation turned out to be wrong?         |
| 2 | How do our assumptions affect the way we see other people?                                  |
| 3 | What does 'seeing what we expect to see' mean in your own life?                             |
| 4 | How could understanding inattentional blindness change the way you communicate with others? |

## Grammar focus

### Passive voice for scientific and academic writing

Academic writing uses the passive to focus on findings rather than researchers: 'has been demonstrated', 'is known as', 'has been shown'. The agent (who did it) is often omitted because it's less important than the finding.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- This has been demonstrated in multiple studies.
- The effect is known as inattentional blindness.
- The brain is not designed to process everything.
- Our perceptions are shaped by expectation.

#### Practice task:

Rewrite 3 active sentences about perception or psychology as passive sentences in a formal register.

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 2 · Autonomy · The freedom to choose yourself

Autonomy, the capacity to make choices that are genuinely your own, is considered by many philosophers to be the foundation of human dignity. But genuine autonomy is rarer than most people assume. Most of our choices are made within structures we did not choose: the culture we were born into, the language we think in, the social roles we have been assigned.

This does not mean we are not free. But it does mean that freedom is not simply the absence of external constraint. It requires something more active, the ongoing work of questioning your assumptions, examining your motivations, and choosing, deliberately, who you want to be rather than defaulting to the version of yourself that the world has handed you.

The existentialists, Sartre, de Beauvoir, Camus, argued that this is both the greatest burden and the greatest gift of human existence. We are 'condemned to be free', as Sartre famously put it. There is no predetermined self, no essence that decides in advance who you are. You construct yourself through your choices.

What this demands in practice is a kind of radical honesty about how much of your life you are living consciously, and how much you are simply following the path of least resistance, doing what is expected, what is comfortable, what you have always done.

## Vocabulary

| Word                   | Part of speech    | Meaning in context                                          | Example                                            |
|------------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>autonomy</b>        | <i>noun</i>       | The right and ability to make your own decisions            | <i>Autonomy is essential to human dignity.</i>     |
| <b>capacity</b>        | <i>noun</i>       | The ability to do or experience something                   | <i>She has the capacity to change.</i>             |
| <b>constraint</b>      | <i>noun</i>       | A limitation or restriction on freedom                      | <i>Freedom is not the absence of constraint.</i>   |
| <b>deliberately</b>    | <i>adverb</i>     | Intentionally and consciously                               | <i>Choose deliberately, not by default.</i>        |
| <b>defaulting</b>      | <i>verb</i>       | Returning automatically to a previous state or behaviour    | <i>We default to familiar patterns.</i>            |
| <b>existentialists</b> | <i>noun (pl.)</i> | Philosophers who focus on individual freedom and choice     | <i>The existentialists valued autonomy deeply.</i> |
| <b>condemned</b>       | <i>adjective</i>  | Forced into a situation one cannot escape                   | <i>We are condemned to choose.</i>                 |
| <b>predetermined</b>   | <i>adjective</i>  | Decided or established in advance                           | <i>There is no predetermined self.</i>             |
| <b>essence</b>         | <i>noun</i>       | The fundamental nature of something                         | <i>Sartre argued existence precedes essence.</i>   |
| <b>radical</b>         | <i>adjective</i>  | Far-reaching and thorough; challenging existing assumptions | <i>This requires radical honesty.</i>              |

|                    |                       |                                                         |                                                |
|--------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>resistance</b>  | <i>noun</i>           | The tendency to remain unchanged or to avoid difficulty | <i>Following the path of least resistance.</i> |
| <b>motivations</b> | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | Underlying reasons for one's actions                    | <i>Examine your own motivations.</i>           |
| <b>assigned</b>    | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | Given to someone as a role or task                      | <i>Social roles are often assigned.</i>        |
| <b>burden</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | A heavy responsibility or weight                        | <i>Freedom is both gift and burden.</i>        |
| <b>consciously</b> | <i>adverb</i>         | In a deliberate and aware manner                        | <i>Are you living consciously?</i>             |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                   | Part of speech        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses        | Example I used it                   |
|------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>autonomy</b>        | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>capacity</b>        | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>constraint</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>deliberately</b>    | <i>adverb</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>defaulting</b>      | <i>verb</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>existentialists</b> | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>condemned</b>       | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>predetermined</b>   | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>essence</b>         | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>radical</b>         | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>resistance</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>motivations</b>     | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>assigned</b>        | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>burden</b>          | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>consciously</b>     | <i>adverb</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>Total</b>           |                       |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <b>_/75</b> | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

**1** How much of your life do you think you chose deliberately versus simply following expectations?

- |   |                                                                                                                    |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 | What does 'genuine autonomy' look like to you?                                                                     |
| 3 | Can you think of a choice you made that was truly your own, not influenced by family, culture, or social pressure? |
| 4 | Do you think the idea that 'there is no predetermined self' is liberating or frightening?                          |

## Grammar focus

### Noun clauses as subjects, 'What this demands...', 'That this is...'

Noun clauses can function as the subject of a sentence: 'What this demands is honesty'. This structure is common in sophisticated analytical writing and shifts emphasis onto the content of the clause.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- What this reveals is how rarely we choose freely.
- That we are shaped by culture is undeniable.
- What surprised me most was the depth of the insight.
- That freedom requires effort is often overlooked.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences with noun clauses as subjects, relating to autonomy, identity, or choice.

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 3 · Language and thought · Words shape worlds

Does language shape the way we think, or does thinking exist independently of the words we use to express it? This question has occupied linguists and philosophers for centuries and remains unresolved.

The strongest version of the theory, known as linguistic determinism, argues that we can only think what we have words for. In the most extreme form, this suggests that a language with no word for 'freedom' produces people who cannot conceive of freedom. Most linguists consider this implausible. But a weaker version, linguistic relativity, associated with Whorf and Sapir, has more empirical support.

Research suggests that the language you speak influences how you categorise time, space, and colour; how you describe agency; and even how you reason about fairness and causation. Russian speakers, who have distinct words for light blue and dark blue, are faster at distinguishing these colours than English speakers. Mandarin speakers think about time more vertically than English speakers.

For language learners, this is a profound finding. When you learn a new language, you do not simply acquire new labels for existing concepts. You gain access to a different way of organising and experiencing reality. Fluency, in this sense, is not just a communication skill, it is a form of cognitive expansion.

## Vocabulary

| Word               | Part of speech   | Meaning in context                                    | Example                                                 |
|--------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>linguistic</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to language or linguistics                   | <i>Linguistic theory explores how language works.</i>   |
| <b>determinism</b> | <i>noun</i>      | The belief that events are controlled by prior causes | <i>Linguistic determinism is a strong claim.</i>        |
| <b>conceive</b>    | <i>verb</i>      | To form or imagine an idea in the mind                | <i>Can you conceive of a world without language?</i>    |
| <b>implausible</b> | <i>adjective</i> | Not seeming reasonable or probable                    | <i>The extreme version seems implausible.</i>           |
| <b>relativity</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | The quality of being relative to something else       | <i>Linguistic relativity has some support.</i>          |
| <b>empirical</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | Based on observation or experiment, not theory        | <i>The evidence is empirical.</i>                       |
| <b>categorise</b>  | <i>verb</i>      | To organise or classify into groups                   | <i>We categorise experience through language.</i>       |
| <b>agency</b>      | <i>noun</i>      | The capacity to act independently                     | <i>Different languages describe agency differently.</i> |
| <b>causation</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | The action of causing something; cause and effect     | <i>Language affects how we think about causation.</i>   |
| <b>distinct</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | Clearly different and separate                        | <i>Russian has distinct words for blue.</i>             |

|                   |                  |                                                             |                                                      |
|-------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>vertically</b> | <i>adverb</i>    | In an up-and-down direction                                 | <i>Time is imagined vertically in some cultures.</i> |
| <b>profound</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | Very deep and significant                                   | <i>This is a profound finding.</i>                   |
| <b>fluency</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | The ability to speak a language naturally and accurately    | <i>Fluency opens new ways of thinking.</i>           |
| <b>cognitive</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to mental processes of knowledge and understanding | <i>Language is a cognitive tool.</i>                 |
| <b>expansion</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | The process of becoming larger or more extensive            | <i>Learning a language is cognitive expansion.</i>   |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word               | Part of speech   | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses        | Example I used it                   |
|--------------------|------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>linguistic</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>determinism</b> | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>conceive</b>    | <i>verb</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>implausible</b> | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>relativity</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>empirical</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>categorise</b>  | <i>verb</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>agency</b>      | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>causation</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>distinct</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>vertically</b>  | <i>adverb</i>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>profound</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>fluency</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>cognitive</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>expansion</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>Total</b>       |                  |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <b>_/75</b> | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

- 1 Do you think differently in different languages? Give an example if you can.
- 2 What concepts exist in your native language that are difficult to translate into English?
- 3 Do you believe language limits or expands thought?
- 4 How has learning English changed the way you see or describe the world?

## Grammar focus

### Hedging language, 'suggests', 'may', 'appears to'

Academic writing uses hedging to avoid making claims too absolute: 'research suggests', 'may influence', 'appears to be'. This shows intellectual honesty and awareness of uncertainty.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- Research suggests that language shapes perception.
- This may explain cultural differences in reasoning.
- It appears that fluency affects cognition.
- Evidence indicates a relationship between language and thought.

#### Practice task:

Rewrite 3 confident statements about language or thought using appropriate hedging language.

*Write your answers here:*

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Review Unit 1

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 1, Unit 2, Unit 3

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

| Word         | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Sentence using the word |
|--------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| perceive     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| demonstrated | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| lens         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| considered   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| prior        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| autonomy     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| deliberately | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| condemned    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| radical      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| assigned     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| linguistic   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| implausible  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| categorise   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| distinct     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| fluency      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used:

1. 
2. 
3. 
4. 
5. 
6. 
7. 
8.

Self-assessment:

How naturally did you use the words?

☐ Very naturally
 ☐ Mostly well
 ☐ Needs more practice

Notes:

Unit 4 · Power and narrative · Who tells the story matters

Every society has a dominant narrative, a story that most of its members accept, more or less consciously, as the explanation of how the world works and how it came to be. These narratives determine what is seen as natural, what is seen as deviant, and who is seen as deserving of power, respect, and resources.

The philosopher Michel Foucault argued that power and knowledge are inseparable. Those who control the production of knowledge, who gets to write the history, define the terms, set the curriculum, also control the narrative. And those who control the narrative control, to a significant degree, how people understand themselves and their place in the world.

This is not a conspiracy theory. It is a structural observation. When the same group of people consistently occupies positions of authority, that group's perspective comes to be seen as neutral, objective, and universal, while all other perspectives come to seem partial, subjective, or marginal.

Understanding this does not mean rejecting all knowledge or descending into cynicism. It means developing the capacity to ask, of any text, any institution, any claim to truth: whose perspective does this represent? What does it include, and what does it leave out? This is the beginning of critical thinking.

## Vocabulary

| Word               | Part of speech   | Meaning in context                                                 | Example                                                   |
|--------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>dominant</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | Most powerful, influential, or widespread                          | <i>The dominant narrative shapes culture.</i>             |
| <b>narrative</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | A story or account that explains how things are                    | <i>Every society has a dominant narrative.</i>            |
| <b>deviant</b>     | <i>adjective</i> | Departing from accepted norms or standards                         | <i>Narratives define what is seen as deviant.</i>         |
| <b>inseparable</b> | <i>adjective</i> | Impossible to separate or consider apart                           | <i>Power and knowledge are inseparable.</i>               |
| <b>curriculum</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | The subjects and content taught in an educational system           | <i>Who controls the curriculum matters.</i>               |
| <b>structural</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to the fundamental structure or organisation of something | <i>This is a structural, not a personal, observation.</i> |
| <b>authority</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | The power to give orders or make decisions                         | <i>Those in authority control the narrative.</i>          |
| <b>objective</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | Not influenced by personal feelings; based on fact                 | <i>No perspective is truly objective.</i>                 |
| <b>marginal</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | Not important; relating to the edge of a group                     | <i>Some voices are treated as marginal.</i>               |
| <b>cynicism</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | The belief that people are motivated only by self-interest         | <i>Critical thinking is not cynicism.</i>                 |

|                    |                  |                                                          |                                                  |
|--------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>partial</b>     | <i>adjective</i> | Showing favour to one side; not complete                 | <i>Every account is partial.</i>                 |
| <b>subjective</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | Influenced by personal feelings and opinions             | <i>All perspectives are somewhat subjective.</i> |
| <b>conspiracy</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | A secret plan by a group to do something unlawful        | <i>This is not a conspiracy theory.</i>          |
| <b>critical</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | Involving careful analysis and judgement                 | <i>Develop your critical thinking skills.</i>    |
| <b>institution</b> | <i>noun</i>      | A large organisation with an established role in society | <i>Institutions shape our understanding.</i>     |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word               | Part of speech   | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | Uses | Example I used it            |
|--------------------|------------------|---|---|---|---|---|------|------------------------------|
| <b>dominant</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>narrative</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>deviant</b>     | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>inseparable</b> | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>curriculum</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>structural</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>authority</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>objective</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>marginal</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>cynicism</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>partial</b>     | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>subjective</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>conspiracy</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>critical</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>institution</b> | <i>noun</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                        |
| <b>Total</b>       |                  |   |   |   |   |   | _/75 | Complete → move to next unit |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|   |                                                                                 |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Whose story was emphasised in the history you learned at school?                |
| 2 | Can you think of a widely accepted narrative that you have started to question? |
| 3 | What does it mean to think critically about a source of information?            |
| 4 | How does the language we use reflect power structures?                          |

## Grammar focus

### Nominalisation, turning verbs into nouns for formal register

Academic and formal writing often uses nominalised forms: 'the production of knowledge' (instead of 'producing knowledge'), 'the rejection of all knowledge'. This creates a more detached, formal tone.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- The rejection of all knowledge would be cynicism.
- The production of narrative is a form of power.
- The development of critical thinking is essential.
- The distribution of resources reflects underlying structures.

#### Practice task:

Rewrite 3 sentences using verbs by nominalising them (e.g. 'he decided' → 'his decision').

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 5 · Fear · The compass of discomfort

Fear has a bad reputation. We talk about 'overcoming' it, 'conquering' it, 'pushing through' it, as if the goal were to eliminate it entirely. But fear is not the problem. Misreading fear is.

Evolutionarily, fear exists for a reason. It is an ancient alarm system designed to alert us to threats. In an environment where those threats were primarily physical, a predator, a fall, a rival, fear was an accurate guide. But our modern fears are almost entirely social and psychological: fear of judgement, fear of rejection, fear of failure, fear of being seen.

The trouble is that these social fears trigger the same physiological response as physical ones. The racing heart, the tight chest, the urge to flee, all of these are activated whether we are facing a bear or a job interview. Our bodies cannot tell the difference.

This creates a perverse outcome. The things that make us most afraid are often precisely the things most worth doing. Starting a difficult conversation. Sharing creative work. Applying for the position you want. Fear, in these cases, is not a warning to turn back, it is a signal that something important is at stake. The question worth asking, when you feel afraid, is not 'how do I eliminate this feeling?' but 'what is this fear pointing me towards?'

## Vocabulary

| Word                  | Part of speech             | Meaning in context                              | Example                                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>reputation</b>     | <i>noun</i>                | The beliefs others hold about a person or thing | <i>Fear has a bad reputation.</i>              |
| <b>evolutionarily</b> | <i>adverb</i>              | In terms of evolution and natural selection     | <i>Evolutionarily, fear serves a purpose.</i>  |
| <b>predator</b>       | <i>noun</i>                | An animal that hunts and kills others for food  | <i>Our ancestors feared predators.</i>         |
| <b>physiological</b>  | <i>adjective</i>           | Relating to the body's physical functions       | <i>Fear produces a physiological response.</i> |
| <b>perverse</b>       | <i>adjective</i>           | Contrary to what is expected or desired         | <i>Fear produces a perverse outcome.</i>       |
| <b>precisely</b>      | <i>adverb</i>              | Exactly; in a way that is accurate and clear    | <i>That is precisely the problem.</i>          |
| <b>stake</b>          | <i>noun</i>                | Something at risk in a situation                | <i>Something important is at stake.</i>        |
| <b>rival</b>          | <i>noun</i>                | A person or group competing with another        | <i>Early fears included rivals.</i>            |
| <b>compass</b>        | <i>noun (metaphorical)</i> | A guide or indicator of direction               | <i>Discomfort can be a compass.</i>            |
| <b>flee</b>           | <i>verb</i>                | To run away from danger                         | <i>The urge to flee is physiological.</i>      |
| <b>activated</b>      | <i>verb (past p.)</i>      | Triggered or set in motion                      | <i>The stress response is activated.</i>       |
| <b>primarily</b>      | <i>adverb</i>              | For the most part; mainly                       | <i>Early threats were primarily physical.</i>  |

|                      |                  |                                           |                                                 |
|----------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| <b>psychological</b> | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to the mind and mental processes | <i>Modern fears are psychological.</i>          |
| <b>eliminate</b>     | <i>verb</i>      | To completely remove or get rid of        | <i>You cannot eliminate fear.</i>               |
| <b>trigger</b>       | <i>verb</i>      | To cause something to happen suddenly     | <i>Social fears trigger physical responses.</i> |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                  | Part of speech                | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses          | Example I used it            |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|---------------|------------------------------|
| <b>reputation</b>     | <i>noun</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>evolutionarily</b> | <i>adverb</i>                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>predator</b>       | <i>noun</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>physiological</b>  | <i>adjective</i>              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>perverse</b>       | <i>adjective</i>              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>precisely</b>      | <i>adverb</i>                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>stake</b>          | <i>noun</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>rival</b>          | <i>noun</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>compass</b>        | <i>noun</i><br>(metaphorical) | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>flee</b>           | <i>verb</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>activated</b>      | <i>verb (past p.)</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>primarily</b>      | <i>adverb</i>                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>psychological</b>  | <i>adjective</i>              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>eliminate</b>      | <i>verb</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>trigger</b>        | <i>verb</i>                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                        |
| <b>Total</b>          |                               |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <u>  </u> /75 | Complete → move to next unit |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|          |                                                                                 |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> | What do you fear most? Is it physical, social, or psychological?                |
| <b>2</b> | Can you think of a time when fear was pointing you towards something important? |

- 3 How do you distinguish between useful fear and irrational fear?
- 4 Has fear ever stopped you from doing something you later wished you had done?

## Grammar focus

### Gerunds after prepositions, 'worth doing', 'of doing'

After prepositions, we use the -ing form (gerund): 'worth doing', 'fear of being seen', 'the goal of eliminating'. This is a common advanced pattern.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- The things worth doing are often frightening.
- Fear of being judged is very common.
- Instead of avoiding discomfort, use it as a guide.
- The goal of eliminating fear is misguided.

#### Practice task:

Write 4 sentences using gerunds after prepositions ('worth', 'instead of', 'the fear of', 'the point of').

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 6 · Inequality · The invisible hand of circumstance

We prefer to believe that success is a product of effort and talent. That those who achieve more, worked harder or were simply more capable. This belief is psychologically convenient, it flatters the successful and assigns responsibility to those who struggle.

But the evidence tells a more complicated story. The most robust predictor of a person's income, education, and health outcomes is not their individual effort or aptitude, it is the circumstances into which they were born: the country, the neighbourhood, the family, the decade.

This is not to say that effort and character do not matter. They do. But they operate on a playing field that is not level. A child born into poverty faces structural disadvantages, in access to nutrition, education, safety, and social capital, that make the same level of effort produce systematically different results.

Acknowledging this is not about removing individual responsibility. It is about accuracy. When we attribute all outcomes to individual choices, we miss the structural forces that shape those choices. And when we miss those forces, we design policies, institutions, and social norms that perpetuate the very inequalities we claim to oppose.

## Vocabulary

| Word                  | Part of speech       | Meaning in context                                                | Example                                              |
|-----------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>predictor</b>      | <i>noun</i>          | A factor that indicates a likely outcome                          | <i>Birth circumstances are strong predictors.</i>    |
| <b>aptitude</b>       | <i>noun</i>          | Natural ability to learn or do something                          | <i>Aptitude alone does not determine success.</i>    |
| <b>robust</b>         | <i>adjective</i>     | Strong and unlikely to change; well-established                   | <i>The evidence is robust.</i>                       |
| <b>structural</b>     | <i>adjective</i>     | Relating to the underlying organisation of a system               | <i>Structural disadvantages are real.</i>            |
| <b>disadvantages</b>  | <i>noun (pl.)</i>    | Conditions that put someone in a worse position                   | <i>Poverty creates systematic disadvantages.</i>     |
| <b>nutrition</b>      | <i>noun</i>          | The process of eating the right food for health                   | <i>Access to good nutrition matters.</i>             |
| <b>social capital</b> | <i>noun (phrase)</i> | Networks and relationships that provide support and opportunities | <i>Social capital opens doors.</i>                   |
| <b>systematically</b> | <i>adverb</i>        | In a methodical, organised, and consistent way                    | <i>Some groups are systematically disadvantaged.</i> |
| <b>attribute</b>      | <i>verb</i>          | To regard something as caused by something else                   | <i>We attribute success to individual effort.</i>    |
| <b>perpetuate</b>     | <i>verb</i>          | To cause something to continue indefinitely                       | <i>Policies can perpetuate inequality.</i>           |
| <b>oppose</b>         | <i>verb</i>          | To be against something; to resist                                | <i>We claim to oppose inequality.</i>                |

|                      |                      |                                                        |                                             |
|----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>flatters</b>      | <i>verb</i>          | Praises or presents in a favourable way                | <i>This belief flatters the successful.</i> |
| <b>convenient</b>    | <i>adjective</i>     | Easy and fitting with one's interests or comfort       | <i>It's a convenient belief.</i>            |
| <b>acknowledging</b> | <i>verb</i>          | Accepting that something is true                       | <i>Acknowledging this is not defeatism.</i> |
| <b>playing field</b> | <i>noun (phrase)</i> | A situation considered in terms of its fairness to all | <i>The playing field is not level.</i>      |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (□). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                  | Part of speech       | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses | Example I used it            |
|-----------------------|----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|------|------------------------------|
| <b>predictor</b>      | <i>noun</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>aptitude</b>       | <i>noun</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>robust</b>         | <i>adjective</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>structural</b>     | <i>adjective</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>disadvantages</b>  | <i>noun (pl.)</i>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>nutrition</b>      | <i>noun</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>social capital</b> | <i>noun (phrase)</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>systematically</b> | <i>adverb</i>        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>attribute</b>      | <i>verb</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>perpetuate</b>     | <i>verb</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>oppose</b>         | <i>verb</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>flatters</b>       | <i>verb</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>convenient</b>     | <i>adjective</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>acknowledging</b>  | <i>verb</i>          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>playing field</b>  | <i>noun (phrase)</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5  |                              |
| <b>Total</b>          |                      |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | _/75 | Complete → move to next unit |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

**1** How much of your success do you attribute to effort and how much to circumstance?

- 2 Do you think the country or family you were born into has had a major impact on your life?
- 3 What does 'a level playing field' mean to you, and do you think it exists?
- 4 How can individuals acknowledge structural inequality without removing personal responsibility?

## Grammar focus

### This is not to say ..., sophisticated concessive structures

Sophisticated argument uses concessive structures to acknowledge opposing points: 'This is not to say that effort doesn't matter. It does.' This pattern shows intellectual fairness and is very effective in debate.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- This is not to deny the role of hard work.
- This is not to say all inequality is identical.
- This does not mean that individuals have no agency.
- This is not about removing responsibility, it is about accuracy.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'This is not to say / deny / suggest ... but ...' to qualify a strong claim.

*Write your answers here:*

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Review Unit 2

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 4, Unit 5, Unit 6

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

| Word           | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Sentence using the word |
|----------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| dominant       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| inseparable    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| authority      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| cynicism       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| conspiracy     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| reputation     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| physiological  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| stake          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| flee           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| psychological  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| predictor      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| structural     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| social capital | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| perpetuate     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| convenient     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used:

1. \_\_\_\_\_

2. \_\_\_\_\_

3. \_\_\_\_\_

4. \_\_\_\_\_

5. \_\_\_\_\_

6. \_\_\_\_\_

7. \_\_\_\_\_

8. \_\_\_\_\_

Self-assessment:

How naturally did you use the words?

☐ Very naturally
 ☐ Mostly well
 ☐ Needs more practice

Notes:

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Unit 7 · Meaning and absurdity · Camus and the art of living anyway

Albert Camus posed a question that he considered the only genuinely serious philosophical problem: why not suicide? Not as a provocation, but as a rigorous starting point. If life has no inherent meaning, if the universe is indifferent, if death renders all projects ultimately futile, then what, he asked, is the rational justification for continuing?

His answer was the concept of absurdity. The human mind, Camus argued, has a deep need for clarity and meaning. The universe offers neither. The gap between our need and reality's silence is what he called 'the absurd'. And the three authentic responses to absurdity, he argued, are: physical suicide (rejected), philosophical suicide, adopting a belief system that falsely resolves the absurdity (also rejected), and revolt: living fully and consciously in the face of meaninglessness.

The model for this revolt, for Camus, was Sisyphus, condemned by the gods to roll a boulder up a hill for eternity, only to watch it roll back down. Camus imagined Sisyphus happy. Not in spite of his condition, but because of his full awareness of it. In accepting the absurd, Sisyphus transcends it.

This is a philosophy for people who have stopped lying to themselves, who face reality as it is and choose, nevertheless, to live with intensity, curiosity, and joy.

## Vocabulary

| Word                 | Part of speech        | Meaning in context                                             | Example                                                |
|----------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>absurdity</b>     | <i>noun</i>           | The quality of being ridiculous, meaningless, or contradictory | <i>Camus embraced the absurdity of existence.</i>      |
| <b>indifferent</b>   | <i>adjective</i>      | Having no interest, concern, or feeling                        | <i>The universe is indifferent to human meaning.</i>   |
| <b>futile</b>        | <i>adjective</i>      | Having no useful result; pointless                             | <i>He felt his effort was futile.</i>                  |
| <b>rigorous</b>      | <i>adjective</i>      | Extremely thorough and careful                                 | <i>His philosophical method was rigorous.</i>          |
| <b>revolt</b>        | <i>noun</i>           | An act of rebellion; here, defiant engagement with life        | <i>Camus advocated revolt against meaninglessness.</i> |
| <b>authentically</b> | <i>adverb</i>         | In a genuine and real way                                      | <i>Live authentically despite uncertainty.</i>         |
| <b>falsely</b>       | <i>adverb</i>         | In a way that is not true or real                              | <i>Don't falsely resolve difficult questions.</i>      |
| <b>boulder</b>       | <i>noun</i>           | A very large, heavy rock                                       | <i>Sisyphus pushed a boulder uphill.</i>               |
| <b>condemned</b>     | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | Sentenced to a particular fate or punishment                   | <i>He was condemned to repeat the task.</i>            |
| <b>eternity</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | Infinite time; a state without end                             | <i>He rolled the boulder for eternity.</i>             |
| <b>transcends</b>    | <i>verb</i>           | Goes beyond the limits of something                            | <i>Acceptance transcends suffering.</i>                |
| <b>intensity</b>     | <i>noun</i>           | Extreme force, energy, or feeling                              | <i>Live with intensity and awareness.</i>              |

|                      |                  |                                                   |                                                      |
|----------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>justification</b> | <i>noun</i>      | A reason or explanation that defends an action    | <i>What is the justification for continuing?</i>     |
| <b>provocation</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | Something intended to cause a reaction or thought | <i>The question was a philosophical provocation.</i> |
| <b>inherent</b>      | <i>adjective</i> | Existing naturally as part of something           | <i>Life has no inherent meaning.</i>                 |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                 | Part of speech        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses        | Example I used it                   |
|----------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>absurdity</b>     | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>indifferent</b>   | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>futile</b>        | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>rigorous</b>      | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>revolt</b>        | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>authentically</b> | <i>adverb</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>falsely</b>       | <i>adverb</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>boulder</b>       | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>condemned</b>     | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>eternity</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>transcends</b>    | <i>verb</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>intensity</b>     | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>justification</b> | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>provocation</b>   | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>inherent</b>      | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>Total</b>         |                       |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <b>_/75</b> | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|          |                                                                                          |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> | Do you believe life has inherent meaning or do you think meaning is something we create? |
| <b>2</b> | How do you respond to the idea that the universe is indifferent to human concerns?       |

3

Can you relate to the image of Sisyphus? Is there anything in your life that feels like pushing a boulder?

4

What does it mean to 'live with intensity' in the face of uncertainty?

## Grammar focus

### Apposition, adding explanation directly after a noun

Apposition places an explanatory phrase directly after a noun, often between commas or dashes: 'Sisyphus, condemned by the gods, '. This is a sophisticated way to embed extra information without a relative clause.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- Camus, a French-Algerian writer, explored absurdity.
- The absurd, a central concept in his work, cannot be resolved.
- Revolt, not despair, is Camus's answer.
- This philosophy, radical in its honesty, remains relevant.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using apposition to embed extra information about a person, idea, or concept.

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 8 · The body and the mind · Why your body keeps the score

For most of Western intellectual history, the mind and body have been treated as separate entities, the mind as the seat of reason and the self, the body as its instrument or vehicle. Descartes formalised this separation in the 17th century, and its legacy continues to shape how we think about health, emotion, and identity.

But contemporary neuroscience tells a radically different story. The mind does not simply send instructions to the body, the body continuously sends information back. Bodily states, posture, heart rate, breathing, gut activity, feed directly into how we feel, think, and perceive. The gut, in fact, contains approximately 100 million neurons and is now often called 'the second brain'.

Trauma researcher Bessel van der Kolk documented what happens when this system is overwhelmed. Traumatic experience is not simply stored as a memory that can be talked about, it is encoded in the body, expressed as chronic tension, hypervigilance, or physical symptoms that persist long after the conscious mind has 'moved on'.

What this means in practice is that emotional healing cannot be purely cognitive. The body must be included. Practices that work directly with bodily experience, breath, movement, somatic awareness, are not alternatives to psychological work. They are a fundamental part of it.

## Vocabulary

| Word                  | Part of speech        | Meaning in context                                           | Example                                               |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>entities</b>       | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | Things that exist separately and distinctly                  | <i>Mind and body are not separate entities.</i>       |
| <b>formalised</b>     | <i>verb (past)</i>    | Made official or established as a formal principle           | <i>Descartes formalised this separation.</i>          |
| <b>legacy</b>         | <i>noun</i>           | Something from the past that continues to affect the present | <i>This legacy shapes modern medicine.</i>            |
| <b>contemporary</b>   | <i>adjective</i>      | Belonging to or occurring in the present time                | <i>Contemporary neuroscience offers new insights.</i> |
| <b>neurons</b>        | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | Nerve cells that transmit information in the brain and body  | <i>The gut has 100 million neurons.</i>               |
| <b>overwhelmed</b>    | <i>adjective</i>      | Completely overcome by too much of something                 | <i>When overwhelmed, the system breaks down.</i>      |
| <b>encoded</b>        | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | Stored or represented in a particular form                   | <i>Trauma is encoded in the body.</i>                 |
| <b>hypervigilance</b> | <i>noun</i>           | A state of extreme alertness and sensitivity to threat       | <i>Trauma often causes hypervigilance.</i>            |
| <b>chronic</b>        | <i>adjective</i>      | Persisting for a long time; not going away                   | <i>Chronic tension is a sign of stress.</i>           |
| <b>somatic</b>        | <i>adjective</i>      | Relating to the body, especially as distinct from the mind   | <i>Somatic therapy works with the body.</i>           |

|                    |                  |                                                           |                                                       |
|--------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>persist</b>     | <i>verb</i>      | To continue for longer than expected                      | <i>Symptoms can persist for years.</i>                |
| <b>posture</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | The position of the body when sitting or standing         | <i>Posture affects how you feel.</i>                  |
| <b>cognitive</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to mental processes of thought and understanding | <i>Healing must be more than cognitive.</i>           |
| <b>fundamental</b> | <i>adjective</i> | Of central importance; forming the base                   | <i>The body is a fundamental part of healing.</i>     |
| <b>vehicle</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | A means of carrying or transmitting something             | <i>The body is not merely a vehicle for the mind.</i> |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                  | Part of speech        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses        | Example I used it                   |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>entities</b>       | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>formalised</b>     | <i>verb (past)</i>    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>legacy</b>         | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>contemporary</b>   | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>neurons</b>        | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>overwhelmed</b>    | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>encoded</b>        | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>hypervigilance</b> | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>chronic</b>        | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>somatic</b>        | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>persist</b>        | <i>verb</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>posture</b>        | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>cognitive</b>      | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>fundamental</b>    | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>vehicle</b>        | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>Total</b>          |                       |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <b>_/75</b> | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

- 1 Have you ever experienced a physical symptom that seemed connected to an emotional experience?
- 2 How do you take care of your body as part of your mental health?
- 3 What do you think of the idea that the body stores trauma?
- 4 Do you think Western culture treats the mind and body as separate? What are the consequences?

## Grammar focus

### Not simply ..., sophisticated correction of oversimplification

The phrase 'not simply' is used to correct an oversimplified view: 'the mind does not simply send instructions'. This signals that the reality is more complex. It is an academic hedging tool.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- The body is not simply a machine.
- Healing is not simply a matter of willpower.
- Language is not simply a tool for communication.
- Memory is not simply a replay of events.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'not simply' to correct an oversimplified understanding of a topic.

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 9 · Technology and attention · The war for your mind

Attention is the currency of the modern economy. Every app, every platform, every notification is designed to capture it. And the companies competing for your attention employ some of the world's most sophisticated psychological research to maximise the time you spend engaged.

This is not an accident or a side effect. It is the business model. Platforms generate revenue through advertising, and advertising value is determined by engagement. Every feature, the infinite scroll, the notification badge, the like button, has been deliberately engineered to exploit psychological vulnerabilities: the need for social validation, the dopamine hit of novelty, the fear of missing out.

The consequences are significant. Research consistently associates heavy social media use with increased anxiety, reduced concentration, impaired sleep, and greater susceptibility to loneliness and depression, particularly in young people. The relationship is not simple, but it is real.

What makes this especially challenging is that these technologies are genuinely useful. This is not a case for technophobia or moral panic. It is a case for intentional use. Understanding that your attention is the product, that you are not the customer but the commodity, changes the relationship. From that position, you can begin to make choices about how and when you engage, rather than being engaged by design.

## Vocabulary

| Word                   | Part of speech             | Meaning in context                                                 | Example                                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>currency</b>        | <i>noun (metaphorical)</i> | Something valuable used as a medium of exchange                    | <i>Attention is the currency of the digital age.</i>     |
| <b>sophisticated</b>   | <i>adjective</i>           | Complex and developed; showing refined knowledge                   | <i>They use sophisticated psychological techniques.</i>  |
| <b>exploit</b>         | <i>verb</i>                | To make unfair use of something for profit                         | <i>Apps exploit psychological vulnerabilities.</i>       |
| <b>vulnerabilities</b> | <i>noun (pl.)</i>          | Weaknesses that leave someone open to harm                         | <i>We all have psychological vulnerabilities.</i>        |
| <b>validation</b>      | <i>noun</i>                | Recognition or affirmation that something is correct or acceptable | <i>We seek social validation online.</i>                 |
| <b>dopamine</b>        | <i>noun</i>                | A brain chemical associated with pleasure and reward               | <i>Likes trigger a dopamine response.</i>                |
| <b>novelty</b>         | <i>noun</i>                | The quality of being new or unusual                                | <i>The brain craves novelty.</i>                         |
| <b>susceptibility</b>  | <i>noun</i>                | The quality of being likely to be affected by something            | <i>Heavy use increases susceptibility to depression.</i> |
| <b>impaired</b>        | <i>adjective</i>           | Weakened or damaged                                                | <i>Screen time impairs sleep quality.</i>                |
| <b>intentional</b>     | <i>adjective</i>           | Done on purpose; deliberate                                        | <i>Use technology intentionally.</i>                     |

|                      |                       |                                                       |                                                      |
|----------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>commodity</b>     | <i>noun</i>           | A raw material or product that can be bought and sold | <i>You are the commodity, not the customer.</i>      |
| <b>techno-phobia</b> | <i>noun</i>           | Irrational fear of technology                         | <i>This is not about techno-phobia.</i>              |
| <b>engineered</b>    | <i>verb (past p.)</i> | Designed and built with a specific purpose            | <i>These features are engineered for engagement.</i> |
| <b>revenue</b>       | <i>noun</i>           | Income generated by a company                         | <i>Platforms generate revenue through ads.</i>       |
| <b>engagement</b>    | <i>noun</i>           | The degree to which users interact with content       | <i>Engagement drives advertising value.</i>          |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                   | Part of speech             | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | Uses | Example I used it                   |
|------------------------|----------------------------|---|---|---|---|---|------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>currency</b>        | <i>noun (metaphorical)</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>sophisticated</b>   | <i>adjective</i>           | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>exploit</b>         | <i>verb</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>vulnerabilities</b> | <i>noun (pl.)</i>          | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>validation</b>      | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>dopamine</b>        | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>novelty</b>         | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>susceptibility</b>  | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>impaired</b>        | <i>adjective</i>           | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>intentional</b>     | <i>adjective</i>           | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>commodity</b>       | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>techno-phobia</b>   | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>engineered</b>      | <i>verb (past p.)</i>      | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>revenue</b>         | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>engagement</b>      | <i>noun</i>                | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5  | _____                               |
| <b>Total</b>           |                            |   |   |   |   |   | _/75 | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|   |                                                                                    |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | How much time do you spend on social media or your phone? Are you happy with that? |
| 2 | Have you noticed any effects of screen time on your mood or attention?             |
| 3 | How do you try to use technology intentionally rather than being used by it?       |
| 4 | Do you think people understand that their attention is the product?                |

## Grammar focus

### Rather than being ..., passive gerund for contrast

'Rather than being + past participle' contrasts an active, intentional state with a passive, controlled one: 'rather than being engaged by design'. This is a subtle and sophisticated construction.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- Rather than being distracted, choose to focus.
- Rather than being used by technology, use it.
- Rather than being defined by circumstances, define yourself.
- Rather than being driven by fear, act from values.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'rather than being + past participle' contrasting passive and active states.

*Write your answers here:*

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Review Unit 3

Recycling vocabulary from Unit 7, Unit 8, Unit 9

Mixed tracking grid

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

| Word            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Sentence using the word |
|-----------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| absurdity       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| rigorous        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| falsely         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| eternity        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| justification   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| entities        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| contemporary    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| encoded         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| somatic         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| cognitive       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| currency        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| vulnerabilities | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| novelty         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| intentional     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| engineered      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |

Cumulative speaking challenge

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

Words I used:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

8.

Self-assessment:

How naturally did you use the words?

☐ Very naturally
 ☐ Mostly well
 ☐ Needs more practice

Notes:

Unit 10 · Ageing · What time teaches

Every culture has a theory of ageing. Many modern Western cultures treat it primarily as decline, a gradual loss of capacity, beauty, and relevance. Other traditions see it differently: as accumulation. As the deepening of experience, the softening of ego, the clarification of what truly matters.

Research in positive psychology has consistently found that emotional wellbeing tends to improve with age, not decline. Older adults report higher levels of emotional regulation, greater life satisfaction, and a more stable sense of identity than younger people. The phenomenon has been called 'the paradox of ageing'.

Part of the explanation lies in what psychologists call 'socioemotional selectivity', the tendency, as time becomes more finite, to prioritise quality of relationships and experience over quantity. Older people are, on average, less concerned with status, less driven by comparison, and more focused on depth than breadth.

The culture that frames ageing as decline loses something important: the knowledge and perspective that only time can produce. Not all knowledge is propositional, storable in books and databases. Some knowledge is embodied: in how to be with difficulty, how to wait, how to lose without being destroyed. That knowledge accumulates. And it has a name: wisdom.

## Vocabulary

| Word                  | Part of speech   | Meaning in context                                       | Example                                                 |
|-----------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>accumulation</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | The process of gathering or building up over time        | <i>Wisdom is an accumulation of experience.</i>         |
| <b>clarification</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | The process of making something clearer                  | <i>Age brings clarification of priorities.</i>          |
| <b>paradox</b>        | <i>noun</i>      | A statement that seems contradictory but is true         | <i>The paradox of ageing surprises people.</i>          |
| <b>socioemotional</b> | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to the emotional aspects of social behaviour    | <i>Socioemotional selectivity explains the paradox.</i> |
| <b>selectivity</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | The tendency to be careful and particular in choices     | <i>Selectivity increases with age.</i>                  |
| <b>finite</b>         | <i>adjective</i> | Having a limit; not endless                              | <i>Time is finite, so we become selective.</i>          |
| <b>prioritise</b>     | <i>verb</i>      | To treat something as more important than other things   | <i>Older adults prioritise depth over breadth.</i>      |
| <b>propositional</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to statements of fact that can be true or false | <i>Not all knowledge is propositional.</i>              |
| <b>embodied</b>       | <i>adjective</i> | Expressed in or existing within a bodily or lived form   | <i>Some wisdom is embodied, not just intellectual.</i>  |
| <b>breadth</b>        | <i>noun</i>      | Width; the extent of something across a large area       | <i>Depth matters more than breadth.</i>                 |

|                   |                  |                                                                     |                                                             |
|-------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>stable</b>     | <i>adjective</i> | Not likely to change or collapse; firmly established                | <i>A stable sense of identity develops with time.</i>       |
| <b>phenomenon</b> | <i>noun</i>      | A fact or event observed to occur                                   | <i>The happiness paradox is a real phenomenon.</i>          |
| <b>relevance</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | The quality of being connected to what is happening                 | <i>Culture wrongly questions ageing people's relevance.</i> |
| <b>ego</b>        | <i>noun</i>      | A person's sense of self-importance                                 | <i>Age often softens the ego.</i>                           |
| <b>wisdom</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | The ability to use knowledge and experience to make good judgements | <i>Wisdom accumulates over a lifetime.</i>                  |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                  | Part of speech   | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses        | Example I used it                   |
|-----------------------|------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>accumulation</b>   | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>clarification</b>  | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>paradox</b>        | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>socioemotional</b> | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>selectivity</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>finite</b>         | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>prioritise</b>     | <i>verb</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>propositional</b>  | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>embodied</b>       | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>breadth</b>        | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>stable</b>         | <i>adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>phenomenon</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>relevance</b>      | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>ego</b>            | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>wisdom</b>         | <i>noun</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>Total</b>          |                  |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <b>_/75</b> | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|   |                                                                                                            |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | How does your culture view ageing? Do you agree with that view?                                            |
| 2 | What have you learned in the last five years that you couldn't have known earlier?                         |
| 3 | Do you think emotional wellbeing really improves with age? Does that match your experience or observation? |
| 4 | What kind of wisdom do you hope to develop over the course of your life?                                   |

## Grammar focus

### The tendency to / the ability to, nominalisations with infinitives

'The tendency to + infinitive', 'the ability to + infinitive' are common formal patterns: 'the tendency, as time becomes finite, to prioritise'. They are formal and flexible.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- The tendency to compare decreases with age.
- The ability to regulate emotion improves over time.
- The inclination to seek depth over breadth grows.
- The capacity to accept loss deepens with experience.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'the tendency to', 'the ability to', or 'the capacity to' about ageing, wisdom, or growth.

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 11 · Memory and truth · The unreliable narrator within

We tend to think of memory as a filing system, a store of accurate records that we retrieve when needed. It is not. Memory is reconstructive. Every time we recall a memory, we rebuild it from fragments, filling in the gaps with inference, expectation, and subsequent experience. The memory we retrieve is not the original event, but our current best interpretation of it.

This has profound implications. Eyewitness testimony, long considered the gold standard of courtroom evidence, is now known to be among the least reliable forms of evidence available. People who witnessed the same event will describe it differently, not because they are lying, but because their brains processed, stored, and reconstructed it differently.

Memory is also highly vulnerable to suggestion. In a now-famous series of experiments, psychologist Elizabeth Loftus demonstrated that it is possible to implant entirely false memories, of childhood events that never happened, simply by asking subjects to repeatedly imagine them. This has had significant consequences for criminal justice, therapy, and our understanding of the self.

If the story of your life, the narrative you carry about who you are and how you got here, is partly constructed rather than simply remembered, then autobiography is a form of fiction. Not necessarily a dishonest one. But a creative act, nonetheless.

## Vocabulary

| Word                  | Part of speech        | Meaning in context                                   | Example                                            |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>reconstructive</b> | <i>adjective</i>      | Built up again from parts rather than stored whole   | <i>Memory is reconstructive, not reproductive.</i> |
| <b>fragments</b>      | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | Small pieces broken off from something larger        | <i>We reconstruct memories from fragments.</i>     |
| <b>inference</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | A conclusion reached through reasoning from evidence | <i>We fill gaps with inference.</i>                |
| <b>subsequent</b>     | <i>adjective</i>      | Coming after something in time                       | <i>Subsequent experiences alter memories.</i>      |
| <b>eyewitness</b>     | <i>noun/adjective</i> | A person who sees an event and can report on it      | <i>Eyewitness testimony can be unreliable.</i>     |
| <b>testimony</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | A formal statement, especially one given in court    | <i>Testimony is often presented as fact.</i>       |
| <b>implant</b>        | <i>verb</i>           | To put something into the mind or body               | <i>False memories can be implanted.</i>            |
| <b>demonstrate</b>    | <i>verb</i>           | To clearly show or prove something                   | <i>Loftus demonstrated this effect.</i>            |
| <b>autobiography</b>  | <i>noun</i>           | An account of someone's life written by themselves   | <i>Our inner narrative is an autobiography.</i>    |

|                       |                  |                                               |                                            |
|-----------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>retrieve</b>       | <i>verb</i>      | To get something back from where it is stored | <i>We retrieve memories imperfectly.</i>   |
| <b>profound</b>       | <i>adjective</i> | Very deep, important, or significant          | <i>The implications are profound.</i>      |
| <b>vulnerable</b>     | <i>adjective</i> | Easily affected by something harmful          | <i>Memory is vulnerable to suggestion.</i> |
| <b>interpretation</b> | <i>noun</i>      | A particular explanation or understanding     | <i>Memory is always an interpretation.</i> |
| <b>nonetheless</b>    | <i>adverb</i>    | In spite of this; nevertheless                | <i>It is fiction, nonetheless.</i>         |
| <b>consequence</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | A result or effect of an action or event      | <i>This has significant consequences.</i>  |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                  | Part of speech        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Uses          | Example I used it                   |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>reconstructive</b> | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>fragments</b>      | <i>noun (pl.)</i>     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>inference</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>subsequent</b>     | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>eyewitness</b>     | <i>noun/adjective</i> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>testimony</b>      | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>implant</b>        | <i>verb</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>demonstrate</b>    | <i>verb</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>autobiography</b>  | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>retrieve</b>       | <i>verb</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>profound</b>       | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>vulnerable</b>     | <i>adjective</i>      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>interpretation</b> | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>nonetheless</b>    | <i>adverb</i>         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>consequence</b>    | <i>noun</i>           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <u>  </u> /5  | _____                               |
| <b>Total</b>          |                       |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          | <u>  </u> /75 | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

- 1 Have you ever remembered an event differently from someone who was also there? What happened?
- 2 How does the idea that memory is reconstructive affect how you think about your own past?
- 3 Do you think the 'story of your life' is mostly accurate or partly a creative construction?
- 4 What are the consequences of unreliable memory for justice, relationships, or therapy?

## Grammar focus

### Long noun phrases, sophisticated nominal groups

Academic writing uses complex noun phrases: 'the narrative you carry about who you are and how you got here'. These pack a lot of meaning efficiently and avoid relative clauses.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- The story we tell about who we are.
- The way memory reconstructs rather than retrieves the past.
- The gap between what happened and what we remember.
- The assumption that memories are accurate records.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 complex noun phrases (without turning them into full sentences) that could begin a sophisticated sentence about memory, identity, or truth.

*Write your answers here:*

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Unit 12 · Civilisation and nature · The world we forgot we belong to

Modern humans spend, on average, over 90% of their time indoors. We live in climate-controlled environments, eat processed food, sleep under artificial light, and spend our working hours staring at screens. We have, in the space of a few generations, become profoundly disconnected from the natural world we evolved in over hundreds of thousands of years.

The consequences of this disconnection are only beginning to be understood. Research into what biologist E.O. Wilson called 'biophilia', the innate human affinity for living systems, suggests that contact with nature is not merely pleasant but biologically necessary. Exposure to natural environments reduces cortisol levels, lowers blood pressure, improves immune function, and restores the kind of directed attention that screens deplete.

There is also a philosophical dimension. Thinkers from Thoreau to indigenous knowledge traditions have argued that the separation of self from nature is not just a physical fact but a cognitive error, a mistaken belief that humans are somehow apart from, rather than part of, the living world.

If this is correct, then many of the psychological and social disorders of modernity, the anxiety, the restlessness, the sense of meaninglessness, may be, at least in part, symptoms of ecological disconnection. And the path back may be simpler, more ancient, and more essential than any of the technologies we have developed to replace it.

## Vocabulary

| Word                | Part of speech   | Meaning in context                                                   | Example                                                     |
|---------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>biophilia</b>    | <i>noun</i>      | Innate human love of and affinity for living systems                 | <i>Biophilia explains our draw to nature.</i>               |
| <b>innate</b>       | <i>adjective</i> | Present from birth; natural rather than learned                      | <i>We have an innate need for nature.</i>                   |
| <b>affinity</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | A natural liking for or attraction to something                      | <i>Humans have an affinity for living things.</i>           |
| <b>cortisol</b>     | <i>noun</i>      | A hormone released in response to stress                             | <i>Nature reduces cortisol levels.</i>                      |
| <b>deplete</b>      | <i>verb</i>      | To reduce or use up a supply of something                            | <i>Screens deplete our directed attention.</i>              |
| <b>indigenous</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | Native to a place; originating there                                 | <i>Indigenous traditions value human-nature connection.</i> |
| <b>cognitive</b>    | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to mental processes                                         | <i>It is a cognitive error to see humans as separate.</i>   |
| <b>restlessness</b> | <i>noun</i>      | The inability to rest or be still; constant movement                 | <i>Modern restlessness may be ecological.</i>               |
| <b>ecological</b>   | <i>adjective</i> | Relating to the relationship between organisms and their environment | <i>We are experiencing ecological disconnection.</i>        |

|                    |                   |                                                   |                                                     |
|--------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>disorders</b>   | <i>noun (pl.)</i> | Disruptions of normal functioning in mind or body | <i>Anxiety is among the disorders of modernity.</i> |
| <b>modernity</b>   | <i>noun</i>       | The quality of being modern; the present age      | <i>Modernity has separated us from nature.</i>      |
| <b>generations</b> | <i>noun (pl.)</i> | Groups of people born and living at the same time | <i>This happened in just a few generations.</i>     |
| <b>profoundly</b>  | <i>adverb</i>     | To a great degree; deeply                         | <i>We are profoundly disconnected from nature.</i>  |
| <b>symptom</b>     | <i>noun</i>       | A sign that something is wrong                    | <i>Anxiety may be a symptom of disconnection.</i>   |
| <b>essential</b>   | <i>adjective</i>  | Absolutely necessary; of the greatest importance  | <i>Nature is essential, not optional.</i>           |

## Word-tracking grid

### Word-tracking grid, how to use it

Each time you use a word in a real conversation, tick one box (☐). Aim for 5 uses before moving on. Do not tick in advance.

| Word                | Part of speech    | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | Uses        | Example I used it                   |
|---------------------|-------------------|---|---|---|---|---|-------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>biophilia</b>    | <i>noun</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>innate</b>       | <i>adjective</i>  | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>affinity</b>     | <i>noun</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>cortisol</b>     | <i>noun</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>deplete</b>      | <i>verb</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>indigenous</b>   | <i>adjective</i>  | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>cognitive</b>    | <i>adjective</i>  | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>restlessness</b> | <i>noun</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>ecological</b>   | <i>adjective</i>  | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>disorders</b>    | <i>noun (pl.)</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>modernity</b>    | <i>noun</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>generations</b>  | <i>noun (pl.)</i> | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>profoundly</b>   | <i>adverb</i>     | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>symptom</b>      | <i>noun</i>       | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>essential</b>    | <i>adjective</i>  | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | _/5         |                                     |
| <b>Total</b>        |                   |   |   |   |   |   | <b>_/75</b> | <i>Complete → move to next unit</i> |

## Speaking prompts

Use these prompts as conversation starters. Try to use as many unit words as possible naturally.

|   |                                                                                                 |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | How connected do you feel to the natural world in your daily life?                              |
| 2 | Have you ever experienced a strong shift in mood or mental state after spending time in nature? |
| 3 | Do you think our psychological problems could be partly ecological?                             |
| 4 | What would it look like to live more in relationship with the natural world?                    |

## Grammar focus

### May be ... at least in part, academic epistemic modality

Academic writing uses epistemic modals to express degrees of certainty: 'may be, at least in part, symptoms of'. This is more honest than 'are' and more nuanced than 'might'. 'At least in part' further qualifies.

#### Examples from the passage context:

- This may be, at least in part, a product of disconnection.
- The anxiety we feel may partially reflect ecological loss.
- Modern disorders may stem, in part, from the built environment.
- This could be, at least partially, explained by evolutionary mismatch.

#### Practice task:

Write 3 sentences using 'may be, at least in part' or similar epistemic hedges to make a qualified claim about society, psychology, or nature.

Write your answers here:

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**Review Unit 4**

*Recycling vocabulary from Unit 10, Unit 11, Unit 12*

**Mixed tracking grid**

Use each word in a new sentence you write yourself. Tick a box each time you use it in conversation.

| Word           | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        | Sentence using the word |
|----------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| accumulation   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| socioemotional | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| prioritise     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| breadth        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| relevance      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| reconstructive | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| subsequent     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| implant        | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| retrieve       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| interpretation | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| biophilia      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| cortisol       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| cognitive      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| disorders      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |
| profoundly     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                         |

**Cumulative speaking challenge**

Use at least 8 of the review words in a single conversation on any topic. Try to connect the words naturally, don't just list them.

**Words I used:**

1. \_\_\_\_\_  
2. \_\_\_\_\_  
3. \_\_\_\_\_  
4. \_\_\_\_\_  
5. \_\_\_\_\_  
6. \_\_\_\_\_  
7. \_\_\_\_\_  
8. \_\_\_\_\_

**Self-assessment:**  
 How naturally did you use the words?  
☐ Very naturally   ☐ Mostly well   ☐ Needs more practice  
  
**Notes:**  
 \_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_  
 \_\_\_\_\_

# Student's guide

## How to use this book

Read to Speak is built around active vocabulary acquisition. Each unit introduces 15 target words through a meaningful passage, then guides learners to use those words in real conversation before marking them as learned. The word-tracking grid is the engine of this method.

## The word-tracking method

The core principle is simple: a word is not learned until it has been used, not studied, not recognised, but genuinely used, at least 5 times in real conversation. The checkbox system makes this visible and motivating.

## Using the passages

Read the passage aloud with learners before studying vocabulary. Ask comprehension questions about meaning and tone. Discuss the topic before introducing the word list, learners should engage with the ideas, not just the language.

## Speaking prompts

These prompts are designed to be impossible to answer without using the unit vocabulary. Push learners beyond single-word answers. Model extended responses. Encourage learners to ask each other follow-up questions.

## Grammar focus

Each grammar point is drawn from the passage itself, not added artificially. Show learners the point in context first. The practice task is intentionally open-ended, accept any grammatically correct response.

## Review units

These appear after every 3 units. They recycle vocabulary from the previous 3 units. Do not introduce new vocabulary during review units. Use the self-assessment section for learner reflection.

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## For self-study learners

Self-study learners should find a conversation partner, a friend, tutor, or language exchange partner, to complete the speaking components. The word-tracking grid works perfectly for solo conversation practice with a partner.

## Adapting for different learners

For stronger learners, encourage use of the vocabulary across topics, not just in direct response to the prompts. For weaker learners, allow use of the word in a simpler sentence before building up.